

Introduction

The word '*Akhlaq*' (اخلاق) is the plural form of '*Khuluq*' (خلق). The meaning of '*Khuluq*' is firm habit, characteristic, attitude, moral, manner and consideration etc. Morals or ethics (*Akhlaq*) refer to the firm habits, attitudes and manners of a human being according to which he/she lives his/her life. The good habits and good attitudes of a person are called *Akhlaq-e-Hasana* (Good Morals) and the bad habits and bad attitudes are called *Akhlaq-e-Sayyiah* (Bad Morals). Good morals are admired in every society while bad morals are disliked in every society. Good morals are sign of a person's great qualities and his/her civilized nature, while bad morals are a sign of his/her bad qualities and his/her uncivilized nature.

'*Aadaab*' (آداب) Etiquettes is the plural form of '*Adab*' (ادب). '*Aadaab*' refers to manners, courtesy and politeness. '*Aadaab*' or Etiquettes means that every work should be done with courtesy, civility, politeness and pleasant manners. In other words, to adopt good manners is *Akhlaq* (morality) and to adopt these qualities in a polite, decent and pleasant manner is *Aadaab* (Etiquettes).

Islam, in its teachings, commands every Muslim to adopt good morals and manners and forbids bad morals and manners. Allah Almighty said in praise of the Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ:

Translation: And you truly are on an exalted (standard of) character.

The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ said:

Translation: I have been sent to complete good morals.

The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ also said:

Translation: The best person is the one who has the best morals.

The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ also said:

Translation: On the Day of Judgment, nothing will weigh more than good conduct in the scale of a believer.

Objectives

In this chapter, topics such as keeping one's promise, forgiveness, tolerance, kindness, frugality, Islamic brotherhood and etiquette of recitation of the Quran have been included so that the students become familiar with them and follow them to become good Muslims and good citizens of Pakistan.

1-Fulfilment of Promise

Learning Outcomes

After studying this lesson, the students will be able to:

- ❖ State the meaning of promise.
- ❖ Write about the importance of keeping promises and disadvantages of breaking the promises.
- ❖ Become true Muslims and good, civilised and a reliable citizens of Pakistan.

Meaning of Promise:

Keeping a promise means to fulfil the promise or statement or an oath made to someone. Generally, keeping a promise means that we should fulfil the promises we make to each other. But the meaning of keeping a promise in Islam is very broad. If they are the promises made to Allah and His *Rasool*, promises made to each other or agreements made with a government or private organization, all of them must be fulfilled. When we recited the *Kalim-e-Tayyiba* 'La ilaha illa Allah Muhammad Rasulullah (لا اله الا الله محمد رسول الله)', we made a promise to Allah Almighty and His *Rasool* صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ that we would follow the commandments of Allah and follow the *Sunnah* of His *Rasool* صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ throughout our lives. Therefore, it is necessary for us to follow the commandments of Allah and the *Sunnah* of the *Rasool-ul-Allah* صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ, in all matters of life. Similarly, when we make a promise to a person or enter into an agreement with an institution, it is also obligatory on us to fulfil and accomplish it. We often make promises to each other, for example, a promise to take something from someone and return it at a certain time, a promise to arrive at a place, a promise to work at a certain time, a promise to help someone, to attend a meeting or event etc. We should fulfil all these promises so that we maintain our trust in each other and can be known as a good Muslim and a responsible citizen.

The Importance of keeping Promises in the Light of Quran and Sunnah:

Allah Almighty has given great importance to keep promises. Therefore, in many of the Ayaat of the Holy Quran, He has commanded to fulfil the promise. Keeping promises is one of the attributes of Allah. Allah states in the Holy Quran:

Translation: This is Allah's true promise, and who can be more truthful in Words than Allah?

[Surah Al-Nisa: 122]

Allah has ordered to embrace the good quality of keeping promises not only to this Ummah, but He also urged the nations of the previous *Ambiya* عَلَيْهِمُ السَّلَام to fulfil their promises. He ordered Bani Israel about keeping their promises in following words:

Translation: Fulfil the promise you made to me. I will fulfil the promise I made to you.

[Surah Al-Nisa: 40]

While commanding the Muslims to abide by their promise, Almighty Allah said:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَوْفُوا بِالْعُقُودِ

Translation: O you people who have believed! Fulfil your promises.

[Surah Al-Maida: 1]

The *Rasool-ul-Allah* صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ emphasized the importance of keeping promises through his words and deeds. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ was so famous for keeping his promises that even the enemies of the Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ used to mention this virtue of the The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. When Abu Sufyan رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ (who had not yet converted to

Islam), the opponent of the Nabi Karim ﷺ, was asked questions in the court of the Roman Empire Caesar, one of the question was that whether the Nabi Karim ﷺ kept his promise or not, Abu Sufyan رضى الله عنه replied: 'He does not break promises.' In the form of the Treaty of *Madinah*, the Nabi Karim ﷺ made an agreement with the Jews. The Nabi Karim ﷺ and the Muslims adhered to it even though the Jews violated this agreement, as a result of that Allah disgraced them.

At the time when the Nabi Karim ﷺ was leaving for the Battle of Badr, Hazrat Hudhayfah رضى الله عنه came with his father Hazrat Yamaan رضى الله عنه from *Makkah* to *Madinah* to visit the Nabi Karim ﷺ and told him that on the way, Abu Jahl stopped them and left them after taking a promise that they will not participate in fight alongside the Nabi Karim ﷺ and his companions. The Nabi Karim ﷺ said: 'Fulfil what you have promised, we will pray for help from Allah against them.' This was an occasion in which the Muslims needed each and every individual, because the polytheist's army was three times more than the Muslim soldiers (*Mujahideen*) and this was a promise taken by force. However, The Nabi Karim ﷺ did not allow them to break the promise.

Hazrat Anas رضى الله عنه has cited that The Nabi Karim ﷺ used to state the following words in each of his sermons:

لَا دِينَ لِمَنْ لَا عَهْدَ لَهُ

Translation: 'He who does not keep his promise has no faith.'

The Nabi Karim ﷺ declared that breaking of promises was one of the signs of hypocrisy. It means that it does not suit a Muslim to break his/her promise, whether he/she made a promise to the common people, to his/her friends or to himself/herself or to the enemies or to the Muslims or non-Muslims. The Muslim always keeps his/her promise whether it is made with weak or strong people. A sea can change its direction and a mountain can move from its place but it is not the characteristic of a Muslim that he/she does not fulfil what he/she utters from his/her mouth or he/she does not accomplish his/her oaths and promises.

Keeping the promise has both individual and collective benefits. It develops people's trust on each other. An atmosphere of trust and honesty is established in the society and such a society is called a civilized and organized one. Therefore, we should prove ourselves to be a good Muslim and civilized citizen by always keeping our promises.

It is learnt from this unit that

- Fulfilment of promise generally refers to the accomplishment of the words said by a person, but in Islam it has very broad meanings.
- Fulfilment of promise is a sign of a good Muslim and civilised citizen.
- In Islam, breaking the promise is a sign of hypocrisy.
- A person who breaks promises is considered unreliable in the society and he/she deserves the punishment of Allah Almighty.

Activity for the students

Students need to organise a speech competition in their class about the fulfilment of promise.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions.

1. State the purpose of keeping a promise?
2. Who was the person who fulfilled all the promises?
3. Explain the importance of keeping promises in Islam?
4. What did Abu Sufyan رضى الله عنه say in the court of Roman Emperor Caesar about The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ?

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

11. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ declared that breaking the promise is a sign of:

- (A) Disbelief (B) Hypocrisy
(C) Sinfulness (D) Belief

12. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ instructed following companions to fulfil their promise with Abu Jahl regarding their participation in the war:

- (A) Hazrat Abu Bakr رضى الله عنه and his father (B) Hazrat Abdullah رضى الله عنه and his father
Hazrat Abu Qahafah رضى الله عنه. Hazrat Abbas رضى الله عنه.
(C) Hazrat Usama رضى الله عنه and his father (D) Hazrat Hudhaifah رضى الله عنه and his father
Hazrat Zayed رضى الله عنه. Hazrat Yamaan رضى الله عنه.

13. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ stated that he has no faith who:

- (A) Does not fulfil his promise. (B) Does not offer his *Namaz*.
(C) Does not keep fast. (D) Does not follow the *Shariah*.

3. Fill in the blanks.

1. Allah does not _____.
2. Allah said: Fulfil the promise you made to me. I will fulfil _____ I made to you.
3. In *Kalimah-e-Tayyibah*, we made a promise to Allah and His *Rasool* صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ that we will follow the commandments of Allah and _____ of The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ.
4. On the Day of Judgment, a person will be questioned about _____.
5. Allah commanded the believers in the Quran: O you people who have believed! Fulfil _____.

4. Match the words in column 1 with appropriate words in column 2 to complete the sentences:

Column 1
1. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ made agreements with the Jews of <i>Madinah</i> and infidels of <i>Makkah</i>
2. In the Holy Quran, those who fulfil their promises
3. Whether a promise is made with an individual or a government or a private organisation
4. Not to present on time for job and to neglect the duties

Column 2
akin to breaking ones promise.
for the establishment of peace.
are declared the successful ones.
it must be fulfilled.

Instructions for the teachers

Explain the lesson according to the intellectual capability of the students by giving more examples from practical life, so that the importance of keeping the promise is highlighted in their minds.

2- Forgiveness and Forbearance

Learning Outcomes

After studying this lesson, the students will be able to:

- ❖ Describe the meaning of forgiveness and forbearance and explain its social significance.
- ❖ Serve their country by becoming good Muslims and civilized citizens of Pakistan.

Forgiveness:

Forgiveness means to be merciful and not to take revenge. It is explained as: To forgive the mistakes and faults of the people and not to take revenge from them for your own sake despite having power and authority to do so. Forgiveness is included in good manners. In its moral teachings, Islam commands to control one's anger and to forgive the mistakes and faults of the people.

This is a fact that whosoever steps in the practical life of the world, at some point or the other, he/she suffers from griefs and agonies in some way or the other. Sometimes from his own relatives, sometimes from strangers, sometimes from elders, sometimes from children, sometimes from friends and sometimes from enemies. Then, the person faces two options, either to take revenge on people for every small thing or try to forgive them as much as possible. Although Islam gives a person the right to take revenge for whatever he has been wronged, but Islam prefers and likes the person to pardon and forgive. Islam has also declared that forgiveness is the highest quality of a human being and a sign of nobility. In fact, the forgiveness is an attribute of Almighty Allah. Allah states in the Holy Quran:

إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَانَ عَفُورًا غَفُورًا

Translation: Indeed, Allah is the Most Pardoning, Often Forgiving.
[Surah Al-Nisa: 43]

The Nabi Karim ﷺ said:

Translation: A strong man is not the one who knocks others down, but a strong man is the one who controls himself when angry.

Regarding forgiveness, the practical life of the Nabi Karim ﷺ is the best example for us. His life was a perfect example of forgiveness and he has left for us a great number of examples of forgiveness to follow.

The people of *Makkah* were the mortal enemies of the Nabi Karim ﷺ who cut off all social relations with the beloved ones and relatives of the Nabi Karim ﷺ for three years in retaliation of the propagation of Islam, and confined them in *She'b* Abi Talib. During this time, they were forced to eat leaves. Eventually The Nabi Karim ﷺ was forced to migrate from *Makkah* with his followers. Even in *Madinah*, they did not allow the Nabi Karim ﷺ to live peacefully. In the Battle of Uhud, they broke the holy tooth of Nabi Karim ﷺ. They made the head and body of the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ bleed. Even then, after overpowering the people of *Makkah* on the occasion of the conquest of *Makkah*, the Nabi Karim ﷺ forgave them all. He not only forgave Abu Sufyan رضى الله عنه, who was a bitter opponent of the Nabi Karim ﷺ (before his acceptance of Islam), but declared that whoever took refuge in his house was also forgiven.

From this example, it is clear that Allah Almighty and His *Rasool* ﷺ love forgiveness and encourage the believers to do the same.

Therefore, we should forgive the shortcomings and mistakes of the people by adopting the attributes of Allah and following the good behavior of the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ. If we commit a mistake that hurts someone, then we must ask him for pardon and forgiveness. By doing this act, we will gain honor in this world and we will also be blessed with success in the Hereafter.

Forbearance:

Forbearance means patience. It is explained as: To bear people's ignorance, unnecessary harshness and their offensive words with courage and not to take personal revenge from them despite having the power and authority to do so. Allah excuses and forgives the offensive words of His servants even though He has the ultimate power and authority to do whatever He wants to do. It is mentioned in the Holy Quran:

إِنَّ اللَّهَ غَفُورٌ حَلِيمٌ

Translation: Allah is Forgiving and Forbearing. [Surah Aal-e-Imran: 155]

Similarly, He loves those among His servants who tolerate the insults of the people, suppress his/her anger, and forgives the faults of the people and is kind to them. As stated in the Holy Quran:

وَالْكَاظِمِينَ الْغَيْظَ وَالْعَافِينَ عَنِ النَّاسِ ۗ وَاللَّهُ يُحِبُّ الْمُحْسِنِينَ

Translation: (those) who restrain their anger and forgive (the faults of the) people; and Allah loves those who are benevolent. [Surah Aal-e-Imran: 134]

A person repeatedly requested the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ to give him some advice. Each time, the Nabi Karim ﷺ said: Do not be angry. While appreciating an individual, the Nabi Karim ﷺ said: There are two qualities in you that Allah loves, one is forbearance and the other is that you are not hasty.

The Nabi Karim ﷺ was very forbearing and tolerant. Tired with the persecution of the polytheists of *Makkah*, the Nabi Karim ﷺ went to Taif to invite the people towards Islam. Instead of accepting the invitation of the Nabi Karim ﷺ, the people of Taif, greatly troubled the Nabi Karim ﷺ and set the street children on him, who threw stones at the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ and he was injured, to the extent that his blessed shoe soles were stained with blood. On this occasion, Hazrat Jibrael عليه السلام appeared in his service and said that Allah Almighty has sent an angel of the mountains for him and he will follow the command of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. After that, the angel of the mountains appeared in front of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. He sent his peace and blessings upon the Nabi Karim ﷺ and said:

Translation: If you give me the order then I will crush the town of Taif between two mountains.

However, the Nabi Karim ﷺ acted with forbearance and forgiveness and said:

Translation: I hope that people of faith will be born from their generations.

It is learnt from this unit that

- Forgiveness means pardoning people's mistakes and faults and not to take personal revenge despite having power to do so.
- Forbearance refers to bearing people's ignorance, unnecessary harshness and their offensive words with patience and strength.
- Forgiveness and forbearance are part of good morals.
- In its moral teachings, Islam orders its followers to control their anger, bear their unpleasant things with patience and forgive the mistakes of the people. In this regard, the life of the Nabi Karim ﷺ is the best practical example to be followed.

This has been the way of the Nabi Karim ﷺ, the Rightly Guided Caliphs and our other predecessors. They continued to bear the ignorance of the people, their unnecessary harshness, and their unpleasant words with patience and forbearance, and they left the best pattern for us to follow. Therefore, we should also develop the high qualities of patience and forbearance in ourselves and live a life following the path of our righteous predecessors so that we can gain a good name in this world and the pleasure of our Lord in the Hereafter.

Activity for the students

Present a role play on the topic of forgiveness and forbearance under the supervision of your teacher.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. Explain the meaning of forgiveness?
2. Write down translation of an Ayat from the Quran about forgiveness?
3. What is meant by forbearance?
4. Give an example of forbearance from the life of The Nabi Karim ﷺ.
5. Explain the benefits of forgiveness and forbearance.

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. Forgiveness literally means:
(A) To take revenge (B) To bear
(C) To show mercy (D) To pardon
2. On the occasion of the conquest of *Makkah*, The Nabi Karim ﷺ treated his enemies by:
(A) Forgiving them (B) Took revenge from them
(C) Gave them capital punishment (D) Imprisoned them
3. The Nabi Karim ﷺ was injured and his shoes were filled with blood by:
(A) People of *Madinah* (B) People of *Taif*
(C) People of *Khyber* (D) Jews
4. The Nabi Karim ﷺ declared that a strong person is the one:
(A) Who defeats others in wrestling (B) Who takes revenge
(C) Who controls his anger (D) Who speaks in a louder voice

3. Fill in the blanks.

1. Forgiveness is one of the _____ of Allah.
2. A person repeatedly requested the *Rasool-ul-Allah* صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ to give him some advice. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ advised him not to be _____.
3. The Nabi Karim's صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ life was a perfect example of _____.

4. Match the words in column 1 with appropriate words in column 2 to complete the sentences:

Column 1
1. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ left great examples of
2. Islam considers forgiveness as a sign of
3. Bearing someone's unpleasant words

Column 2
a great quality and human dignity.
is forbearance.
forgiveness and forbearance.

Instructions for the teachers

Narrate more events related to forgiveness and forbearance from the lives of the Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and the Companions رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُمْ to the students.

3-Tolerance

Learning Outcomes

After studying this lesson, the students will be able to:

- ❖ Describe the meaning of tolerance and explain its social significance.
- ❖ Write some points about tolerance from the teachings of Islam.
- ❖ Develop qualities of a civilised and well-behaved citizen.

Tolerance:

Tolerance means to bear, to endure, to abide, to accept, to approve and to allow etc. It means to tolerate the beliefs, opinions, thoughts and ideas of others against your own with patience and to treat them with kindness, and to give them the right to live according to their thoughts and beliefs. For example, if a person or a group has a belief or creed other than Islam, then listening to him/her and giving him/her the right to continue according to his/her creed and belief is called 'tolerance'. On the contrary, to force a person to follow a creed or belief other than his/her creed or belief or to stop him/her to act according to his/her belief is against tolerance.

Since Islam is a religion of tolerance, it gives every person the right to live according to his/her own beliefs, creeds and thoughts and it does not allow anyone to interfere in the faith or creed of others nor prevents him/her to act according to his/her religion and beliefs. Allah states in the Holy Quran:

لَا إِكْرَاهَ فِي الدِّينِ

Translation: There is no compulsion in religion. [Surah Al-Baqarah: 256]

At another place in the Holy Quran, Allah Almighty states:

Translation: To you be your religion and to me my religions. [Surah Al-Kafiroon: 6]

Islam teaches tolerance and forbids using abusive language and hate speech against non-Muslims. In the same manner, it also prohibits injustice and misbehaviour with someone due to differences in the faith and religion. In this regard, various instructions have been provided by Allah Almighty in many Quranic Ayaat.

Tolerance in the Light of the Life of The Nabi Karim ﷺ and the Companions رضي الله عنهم

The Nabi Karim ﷺ used to remain patient and tolerant with the non-Muslims and his opponents. The Nabi Karim ﷺ said:

مُدَارَاةُ النَّاسِ صَدَقَةٌ

Translation: Being tolerant towards people is charity.

The Nabi Karim ﷺ never forced any non-Muslim to leave his faith or accept Islam, nor did he allow ill-treatment of them on the basis of faith. Rather, in this regard, he used to show benevolence and a generous disposition.

Once, a delegation of Christian scholars and leaders from Najran came to meet the Nabi Karim ﷺ. The Nabi Karim ﷺ accommodated them in Masjid-e-Nabawi ﷺ and treated them with great hospitality. Since it was Sunday, the Christians wanted to perform worship according to their Christian beliefs and practices, thus the Nabi Karim ﷺ allowed them to worship in his Masjid.

The leader of Yamamah, Thumama bin Uthal, was a strong opponent of the Nabi Karim ﷺ and a polytheist. He was captured by the Companions of the Nabi Karim ﷺ. They brought him in front of the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ. The Nabi Karim ﷺ said: 'Keep him in the *Masjid* and treat him well.' The Nabi Karim ﷺ found out that he used to eat the food of ten people to fill his stomach, hence, he arranged sufficient quantity of meal for him. After three days, the Nabi Karim ﷺ ordered to release him. Thumama was so impressed by the tolerance and kindness of the Nabi Karim ﷺ that he did not return without accepting Islam.

In *Madinah*, the funerals of the Jews used to pass through the streets. Whenever they would pass by the Nabi Karim ﷺ would stand up to pay respect to them. At one point, someone pointed out to the Nabi Karim ﷺ that it was the funeral of a Jew. Allah's *Rasool* replied: 'Is he not a human being?'

During the reign of the Rightly Guided Caliphs *Dhimmis* (non-Muslim citizens) enjoyed the same rights which they enjoyed during the reign of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. During the reign of Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddique رضي الله عنه and Hazrat Umar Farooq رضي الله عنه, non-Muslim citizens were given following rights in writing:

- *Dhimmis* (Non-Muslim residents of Islamic State) will have religious freedom, their places of worship and monasteries will be protected.
- No pressure shall be imposed on them in respect of faith and religion.
- Their forts and strongholds will not be damaged.
- Their lives and properties will be protected.
- Their disabled and deprived people will be supported from *Bait-ul-Mal* (public treasury). *Jizya* (government tax) will not be taken from their poor and deprived ones.

Muslims ruled the sub-continent of Pakistan and India with great magnificence for almost a thousand years, but they did not forcibly convert any non-Muslim to Islam. Muslims showed great tolerance towards the non-Muslims and awarded them important positions in their governments.

Scope and Benefits of Tolerance:

Tolerance does not mean that we stop following the Islamic rules or change them in order to please the people of other religions. As the people of other religions have the right to follow their religious teachings, likewise, Muslims also need to follow their religious teachings. Just as it is necessary for the Muslims to respect the beliefs, places of worship and religious leaders of others, it is also necessary for the people of other religions to respect Islamic beliefs, *Masjids* and leaders of the Muslims.

In our beloved homeland Pakistan, there are people who follow different religions and among Muslims, there are people who belong to different sects. Therefore, the social significance of tolerance increases even more here. Thus, it is necessary for all the residents of Pakistan to respect each other's religions and beliefs and treat each other with tolerance and forbearance so that hatred and enmity can be ended from our beloved country and an atmosphere of peace and order, mutual love and brotherhood can be established in Pakistan.

It is learnt from this unit that

- Tolerance refers to show respect for each other's religion.
- Islam is a religion of tolerance, which gives everyone the freedom to follow their religion and does not allow anyone to interfere in the religious affairs of others.
- Islam does not allow anyone to be deprived of a country's rights on the basis of differences of religion and creed.
- Nabi Karim ﷺ and the Rightly Guided Caliphs have left excellent examples of tolerance towards non-Muslims.
- It is known from the life of The Nabi Karim ﷺ and the Companions رضي الله عنهم that all the inhabitants of a country are equal in terms of religious freedom, economic, social and other rights.

Activity for the students

Students need to write a five-line essay on the topic of tolerance in nice hand writing and present it to the class.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. Write down the meaning of tolerance.
2. Write down the meaning of an Ayat of the Quran related to tolerance.
3. How did The Nabi Karim ﷺ treat the Christian delegation of Najran?
4. Which rights were given by Hazrat Abu Bakr رضي الله عنه and Hazrat Umar رضي الله عنه to *Dhimmis* (Non-Muslims living in Islamic State under protection)?

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. Tolerance means:
(A) To bear (B) To believe
(C) To serve (D) To annoy
2. Thumama bin Uthal belonged to:
(A) Makkah (B) Bahrain
(C) Madinah (D) Yamamah
3. Thumama bin Uthal was so much impressed by the tolerance and good behaviour of The Nabi Karim ﷺ that he:
(A) Accepted Islam (B) Gave a present to The Nabi Karim ﷺ
(C) Helped The Nabi Karim ﷺ in a war (D) Resided in Madinah permanently

3. Fill in the blanks.

1. There is no _____ in matter of religion.
2. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ treated *Dhimmis* (non-Muslim residents of Islamic state) with _____.
3. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ used to stand up in respect while the _____ of the Jews passed through the streets of *Madinah*.
4. Muslims ruled the sub-continent for almost _____.

 Instructions for the teachers

Explain the topic of tolerance to the students with more examples.

4-Mercy

Learning Outcomes

After studying this lesson, the students will be able to:

- ❖ Describe the meaning of Mercy and explain its social significance.
- ❖ Understand and explain teachings of Islam about Mercy.
- ❖ Become merciful and well-mannered individuals after reading practical examples from the life of The Nabi Karim ﷺ.

Mercy:

Mercy means treating Allah's creatures with gentleness, love and compassion and practically giving them all kinds of sympathy and help whether it is physically, financially or morally. Allah Almighty, who is the Most Compassionate and the Most Merciful, has mercy on His creation and He demands the same from His servants that they adopt a merciful attitude towards His creation.

Creation of this universe and provision of all the necessities of life is the result of Allah's mercy. Not withholding sustenance of humans due to their sins and mistakes is an expression of Allah's attribute of mercy, love and compassion, حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ ﷺ said:

Translation: All creation is the family of Allah Almighty and Allah Almighty likes the person who treats his family well.

The Nabi Karim ﷺ also said:

إِرْحَمِ مَنْ فِي الْأَرْضِ يَرْحَمَكَ مَنْ فِي السَّمَاءِ

Translation: Have mercy on those on earth, the one in heaven will have mercy on you.

Mercy in the Light of The Nabi Karim's Life: The Nabi Karim ﷺ was unparalleled in mercy. He has left great examples for the Muslims to follow in this regard. He was a mercy to all including children, adults, relatives, strangers and animals etc. Allah made him a mercy for the universe. Allah states in the Holy Quran:

وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَاكَ إِلَّا رَحْمَةً لِّلْعَالَمِينَ

Translation: And We have not sent you (O حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ ﷺ) but as a Mercy for the worlds. [Surah Al-Ambiya: 107]

The Nabi Karim ﷺ was severely persecuted by the disbelievers and polytheists, but he never took revenge on anyone for his own sake. He was always merciful and forgiving. The Nabi Karim ﷺ always respected the elders and he was kind with the younger ones. He used to say: 'He who does not respect the elders and does not show compassion to the younger ones is not one of us.' If someone brought a child in front of the Rasool-ul-Allah ﷺ, he would display affection to it and made it sit on his lap. He described the attributes of the believers and said:

'You will see that the believers are like one body in compassion, love and kindness to one another. When one part of the body suffers, the whole body suffers from sleeplessness and fever.'

This means that all believers should be like one body in showing mercy, love and kindness to each other. The Nabi Karim ﷺ used to teach compassion not only for humans but also for

animals. Once a companion picked up a baby bird. The mother bird started circling upon his head in distress. When the Nabi Karim ﷺ came to know about the distress of the mother bird, he immediately instructed the companion to put the baby bird back in its nest. The Nabi Karim ﷺ also mentioned that a person was forgiven by Allah when he took pity on a thirsty dog and gave it water. A woman imprisoned a cat and kept it hungry. That cat died because of hunger and thirst, so Allah gave this woman the punishment of hell. Similarly, The Nabi Karim ﷺ also forbade the people to make the animals fight with each other, as it was a display of cruelty. The Nabi Karim ﷺ also said:

مَنْ لَا يَرْحَمُ لَا يُرْحَمُ

Translation: He who does not show mercy to others will not be shown mercy.

Nabi Kairm ﷺ was not only merciful and kind himself, but his trained Companions رضى الله عنهم were also very merciful and kind. They always treated each other with kindness, compassion and love and preferred others over themselves. Financially, wealthy Companions رضى الله عنهم used to help the poor Companions رضى الله عنهم with their wealth. The Companions رضى الله عنهم also tried to surpass each other in goodness and kindness. That is why Allah said in their praise:

رُحَبَاءٌ بَيْنَهُمْ

Translation: They are kind-hearted and merciful amongst themselves.
[Surah Al-Fath: 29]

Benefits of Mercy:

Mercy or compassion is a moral quality which brings a person closer to Allah Almighty and increases love and affection between each other. An atmosphere of faith and brotherhood is established in the society, prosperity rises in the country and finally it leads to the salvation of the hereafter.

Therefore, we should show generosity and treat each other with mercy and love. In this way, blessings like peace, love and harmony can be attained in our beloved country Pakistan and a good society can be formed, similar to the society of the era of the Rightly Guided Caliphs.

It is learnt from this unit that

- Mercy means treating Allah's creation with gentleness and love.
- Mercy is extremely important in Islam.
- Mercy leads to mutual love and brotherhood, peace and tranquillity. Kindness and mercy are the source of Allah and His Rasool's ﷺ love and a source of salvation in the hereafter.
- Therefore, we should act generously and be merciful to each other.

Activity for the students

Write the following Ayat of the Quran with its translation in a neat and clean manner and show it to your teacher.

وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَاكَ إِلَّا رَحْمَةً لِّلْعَالَمِينَ

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

- What is meant by mercy?
- Write down the meaning of any Hadith of The Nabi Karim ﷺ related to mercy.
- State any example of The Nabi Karim's ﷺ mercy.
- What did Allah Almighty say about the mercy of the Companions رضي الله عنهم?

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

- Mercy gives a man in a society:

(A) Respect	(B) Wealth
(C) Authority	(D) Fame
- The man who fetched water for a dog was given by Allah:

(A) Forgiveness	(B) Public post
(C) Wealth	(D) Punishment
- The Nabi Karim ﷺ stated that the one who does not respect elders and does not show kindness to the younger ones is:

(A) Not a Muslim	(B) Not from us
(C) Not a pious man	(D) Not a benevolent man
- Allah made The Nabi Karim ﷺ for the worlds:

(A) Tolerant	(B) Forbearing
(C) Sympathetic	(D) Mercy

3. Fill in the blanks.

- Allah Almighty also shows _____ to his creatures.
- Have mercy on those on earth, the _____ will have mercy on you.
- He who does not show mercy to the others will not _____ mercy.
- The Nabi Karim ﷺ forbade the people to make the animals _____ with each other.

4. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (×) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. Kindness means to be harsh with the creation of Allah and hate them.	☐	☐
2. The Nabi Karim ﷺ did not take revenge for his own sake.	☐	☐
3. A women imprisoned a dog and kept it thirsty and hungry.	☐	☐
4. Mercy brings a person closer to Allah.	☐	☐
5. Rich Companions رضي الله عنهم would help the needy ones with their wealth.	☐	☐

Instructions for the teachers

Narrate more stories about mercy from the life of The Nabi Karim ﷺ and the other noble Muslim ancestors to the students.

5-Frugality

Learning Outcomes

After studying this lesson, the students will be able to:

- ❖ State the meaning of frugality and explain its significance.
- ❖ State the benefits of frugality.
- ❖ Explain the disadvantages of being a miser and an extravagant.
- ❖ Become a content, satisfied and frugal Muslim.

Frugality:

To spend wealth according to the needs while avoiding extravagancy and unnecessary spending of wealth is called Frugality. It refers to the careful management of material resources, especially money. It is a moral quality which makes a person wealthy and peaceful. Moreover, it can save the individual from begging and seeking financial help from others.

Frugality in the Light of the Quran and *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ:

Islam is a religion that teaches man to adopt the path of moderation and balance in every matter. Islam does not like the individual to go beyond the limit or to be left behind in any matter. Since wealth is the main source and support of human life, Islam teaches moderation and balance in its spending. Thus, Allah describes the qualities of His special servants and states:

Translation: And (these) are the people who are neither extravagant nor miserly when they spend. And their spending is (based on) a balance between the two extremes (of extravagance and miserliness). [Surah Al-Furqan: 25-67]

Islam praises those who spend with moderation and not those who are extravagant or miserly. Allah Almighty prohibits extravagancy and states:

وَكُلُوا وَاشْرَبُوا وَلَا تُسْرِفُوا إِنَّهُ لَا يُحِبُّ الْمُسْرِفِينَ

Translation: Eat and drink, but do not spend extravagantly because certainly He does not like the extravagant. [Surah A'raaf: 31]

The Nabi Karim ﷺ said:

خَيْرُ الْأُمُورِ أَوْسَطُهَا

Translation: The best work is that which is based on moderation.

The opposite of frugality is miserliness and extravagance. Miserliness refers to being so stingy in spending money that even legitimate needs are not met. Extravagance means wasteful and unnecessary spending of wealth.

Islam neither likes greed and miserliness, nor extravagance and wastefulness, as all these things are against moderation.

Miserliness is not only a bad trait itself, but it is the root of many other bad traits evils such as betrayal, dishonesty, impudence, cruelty, misbehaviour, greed, voracity and narrow-mindedness etc. are all born due to this bad trait.

Wasteful spending makes a person suffer from financial hardship, due to which a person adopts illegal means to earn sustenance and indulges in sinful acts.

Benefits of Frugality:

- By adopting frugality, a person can live a great life.
- Because of frugality a person does not need to ask others for financial help.
- Frugality leads to economic prosperity and ends economic hardship.

- By adopting frugality, a person is protected from many sins. One seeks halal (lawful) sustenance instead of haram (unlawful) sustenance.
- Due to frugality a person gets peace of mind.
A frugal person can help others in times of need, while an extravagant person needs help from others.

It is learnt from this unit that

- Frugality means to spend according to the need and to avoid being miserly and extravagant.
- Islam has praised frugality while it has disliked being miserly and extravagant.
- Frugality saves a person from poverty and begging from others.
- Miserliness causes disgrace to a person while extravagance may instigate a person to indulge in unlawful (haram) things and lead to begging from others.
- Frugality leads to mental peace and prosperity.
- A frugal person can help others at the time of need while no good can be expected from a miser, and an extravagant mostly remains in a destitute and needy condition.

So, we should adopt frugality, avoid extravagance and miserliness so that we can attain the pleasure of Allah and live a successful life in this world and the hereafter.

Activity for the students

Students need to present a role play in front of their teachers on the topic of frugality.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions.

1. What is meant by frugality?
2. Explain miserliness.
3. Explain attribute of extravagance.
4. Write a Hadith of The Nabi Karim ﷺ about moderation and balance.
5. Write the meaning of any Quranic Ayat about frugality.

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. Frugality means:

(A) Extravagance	(B) Miserliness
(C) To spend wealth without any need	(D) To spend wealth according to the need
2. Islam's view about extravagant people:

(A) It condemns them	(B) It praises them
(C) It appreciates them	(D) Promotes brotherhood
3. Opposite of frugality:

(A) Honesty	(B) Truthfulness
(C) Faithfulness	(D) Misery and extravagance

3. Fill in the blanks.

1. By adopting frugality, a person can spend a great _____.
2. Islam _____ those who spend with moderation.
3. Extravagance may instigate a person to indulge in _____.

4. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

<i>Sentence</i>	<i>Right</i>	<i>Wrong</i>
1. Islam teaches a person to be moderate and balanced in each and every matter.	☐	☐
2. A person who adopts moderation remains destitute.	☐	☐
3. Frugality means miserliness and extravagance.	☐	☐
4. Islam does not like miserliness and stinginess.	☐	☐

 Instructions for the teachers

Explain few more examples of frugality to the students in a good way.

6-Islamic Brotherhood

Learning Outcomes

After studying this lesson, the students will be able to:

- ❖ Write the meaning and benefits of Islamic brotherhood.
- ❖ Know and explain the Islamic teachings about Islamic brotherhood.
- ❖ To develop feelings of compassion for the Islamic community.

Brotherhood:

In Arabic, the word 'Ukhuwwat' (اخوة) is used for brotherhood. Islamic brotherhood means that all Muslims, regardless of colour, race, language and country are brothers. Allah Almighty states the following about the brotherhood of Muslims:

إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ إِخْوَةٌ

Translation: The Muslims are brothers to one another. [Surah Al-Hujrat: 10]

In another Ayat of the Holy Quran, Allah Almighty states:

وَالْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتُ بَعْضُهُمْ أَوْلِيَاءُ بَعْضٍ

Translation: The Believers, men and women, are helpers and friends of one another. [Surah Al-Tauba: 71]



Muslim Brotherhood in the Light of the Life of The Nabi Karim ﷺ

People of Arabia were divided into different tribes before the advent of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. They used to fight on the basis of colour, race and tribal prejudices. Sometimes tribal clans were destroyed due to battles based on tribal prejudices. Due to the teachings and practical examples of the life of The Nabi Karim ﷺ, they became brothers. When the Nabi Karim ﷺ migrated from Makkah to Madinah, he established brotherhood among the Muhajireen (emigrants) and Ansar (helpers), as a result of which unique sacrifice and brotherhood was shown by the Ansar (helpers). An example like this is not found in any other nation of the world.

The Nabi Karim ﷺ has emphasized Islamic brotherhood in his blessed Ahadith. The Nabi Karim ﷺ said: 'A Muslim is a brother of another Muslim. He does not oppress him and does not abandon him. He does not humiliate him.'

Giving an example of the strength of Muslim brotherhood, The Nabi Karim ﷺ said: 'Believers to one another are like the bricks of a wall, each one is strengthened by the other one.' The Nabi Karim ﷺ emphasized the protection of the lives and property of the believers and said: Every Muslim has a duty to respect the life, honour and property of another Muslim.

On the occasion of Hija-tul-Wada (Farewell Pilgrimage), the Nabi Karim ﷺ said the following about brotherhood:

“O people, listen to me carefully, be aware that every Muslim is the brother of another Muslim, it is not permissible for a person to take his brother’s property unless he gives it of his own free will, and be kind to each other”.

Islam abolished the differences of colour, race, language and homeland and made all Muslims brothers on the basis of the religion of Islam. The Nabi Karim ﷺ called Hazrat Salman Farsi رضي الله عنه a member of his household. Hazrat Umar رضي الله عنه used to call Hazrat Bilal رضي الله عنه as his master and his chief, even though Hazrat Bilal رضي الله عنه was a freed slave.

Importance of Islamic Brotherhood:

The principle of Islamic brotherhood created unity and harmony among Muslims. Islam not only provided teachings about the bond of brotherhood, but also gave such orders and injunctions which promoted unity among the Muslims. For example, Muslims were given a single *Kalimah* which they all read. They are ordered to offer *Namaz* five times a day in congregation. This is why many Muslims are seen in the *Masjids* five times a day every day. They are ordered to fast in the month of Ramadan, which creates a feeling of mutual sympathy and kindness. The rich have been ordered to pay *Zakat* to the poor due to which the hearts of the rich and the poor are connected. They are ordered to perform Hajj, in which a large gathering of Muslims from all over the world is seen together. All these orders and commands create unity and harmony among the Muslims and they are clear examples of the unity of the Islamic nation.

On the occasion of *Hijja-tul-Wada* (Farewell Pilgrimage), the Nabi Karim ﷺ said: Behold! Don’t go astray after me (my departure from this world), and do not kill each other. The Nabi Karim ﷺ declared it undesirable for two Muslims to be angry with each other for more than three days. It was the result of the Nabi Karim’s ﷺ teachings that the Bedouin tribes of the Arabia, who were thirsty for each other’s blood, became brothers among themselves and showed unprecedented brotherhood.

Benefits of Brotherhood:

Islamic brotherhood creates love, compassion, benevolence and self-sacrifice among the Muslims. The principle of brotherhood promotes respect for other Muslims. Due to this relationship, Muslims take part in each other’s sufferings and help them, which increases love.

It is learnt from this unit that

- Islamic Brotherhood means that all Muslims are brothers.
- Islam removed all the differences of colour, race, language and homeland and established the relationship of brotherhood.
- Allah declared the relationship of brotherhood a great blessing and emphasized on making it strong and stable.
- The Nabi Karim ﷺ called the entire Islamic community a single body, in his teachings. He also urged Muslims to stand united, take care of each other’s life, property and honour. Furthermore, he prohibited them from fighting and quarrelling with one another.

Activity for the students

Students need to present a play about brotherhood.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions.

1. State the meaning of Islamic brotherhood.
2. Write down the translation of a Quranic Ayat related to brotherhood.
3. Explain the importance of Islamic brotherhood.
4. Write down the benefits of Islamic brotherhood.
5. How does Islamic worships and *Namaz* strengthen the relationship of Islamic brotherhood?

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. Brotherhood literally means:

(A) Friendship	(B) Sympathy
(C) Love	(D) Being brothers
2. The situation of the Arabia before the advent of The Nabi Karim ﷺ was:

(A) They were divided into tribes	(B) They were like brothers
(C) They were like friends	(D) They were each other's well-wishers
3. Hazrat Umar رضي الله عنه used to call him 'My Master':

(A) Hazrat Zaid bin Harith رضي الله عنه	(B) Hazrat Khubbab رضي الله عنه
(C) Hazrat Bilal رضي الله عنه	(D) Hazrat Khubaib رضي الله عنه

3. Fill in the blanks.

1. Muslims are each other's _____.
2. The Nabi Karim ﷺ established the relationship of brotherhood among the *Muhajireen* and _____.
3. The Nabi Karim ﷺ declared it undesirable for two Muslims to be angry with one another for more than _____ days.

Instructions for the teachers

Give examples of brotherhood to the students from the era of the Companions of The Nabi Karim ﷺ and history of Islam.

7-Manners of Recitation

Learning Outcomes

After studying this lesson, the students will be able to:

- ❖ State the introduction to the Holy Quran.
- ❖ Write down the importance and virtues of reciting the Holy Quran.
- ❖ State the manners of the recitation of the Quran.

Quran means, the book which is read the most. As this book is read a lot, hence it is named as the Quran. The Holy Quran is the source of guidance for all human beings. In it, Allah Almighty has provided the ways and rules of life and such instructions, that by following them, a person can achieve success in both worlds.

The Holy Quran is the last divine book of Allah which He revealed to حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ through Hazrat Jibreel عليه السلام, gradually over a period of about 23 years. From the time of the Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ, millions of the people have been reading it, understanding it, memorizing it, preserving it and passing it on to the future generations. The Holy Quran is the last revealed book of Allah and He has taken responsibility of protecting it. Due to this reason, despite the passage of more than fourteen hundred years, it is preserved in its original form without any manipulation or corruption. Allah Almighty states:



إِنَّا نَحْنُ نَزَّلْنَا الذِّكْرَ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ

Translation: It is We who have sent down the Reminder and We will, most surely, safeguard it. [Surah Al-Hijr: 9]

Reward of Reciting the Quran:

Allah has made the recitation of the Quran necessary for every Muslim. Allah states in the Holy Quran:

فَاَقْرَأْ وَمَا يَنْصُرُكَ مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ

Translation: Recite, then, as much of the Quran as it is easy for you. [Surah Al-Muzzammil: 20]

Reciting the Holy Quran is an act of great reward. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ said: 'Reciting one letter of the Holy Quran yields ten good deeds. He also said: 'The best worship of my Ummah is the recitation of the Holy Quran.' At another place, the Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ said: 'Allah gives more to the reciter of the Quran than to the supplicant.' In the Ahadith, the great virtues of the recitation of the Holy Quran have been mentioned, hence, we should recite the Holy Quran daily.

Manners of Recitation of the Quran:

Regarding the recitation of the Holy Quran, it should be kept in mind that it is not an ordinary book but the greatest book of Allah Almighty, therefore it should not be read like ordinary books. There are certain manners, according to which it should be recited:

- It is very important to be neat, clean and purified before touching the Quran.

- Recitation of the Holy Quran should be done while sitting at a clean and purified place.
- Before starting the recitation of the Holy Quran, it is necessary to read *Ta'awwuz* i.e. اَعُوْذُ بِاللّٰهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطٰنِ الرَّجِيْمِ and *Tasmiyah* i.e. بِسْمِ اللّٰهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيْمِ .
- It is not appropriate to talk during the recitation of the Holy Quran.
- Recitation of the Holy Quran should be done slowly and distinctly with serenity and contentment.
- While reciting the Holy Quran, one should take care of phonetic symbols i.e., *Zair, Zabar, Paish, Shadd* and *Madd* etc.
- It is very important to take care of the *Rumooz-o-Awqaaf* (punctuation) during the recitation, i.e., where to stop during the recitation and where to continue.
- Recitation of the Holy Quran can be done in loud and slow voices. While reciting in a loud voice, it should be kept in mind that no one is disturbed by it.
- The Holy Quran should be recited beautifully and in a pleasant voice.
- Recitation of the Holy Quran should be done with attention and regularity.
- One should understand the Quran and act upon its teachings.



The recitation of the Holy Quran should not be considered a burden, rather it should be recited with respect and courtesy, and attention should be paid to its meanings. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّمَ said: 'The best amongst you is the one who learns the Quran and teaches it to others.'

It is learnt from this unit that

The Holy Quran is the last divine book of Allah which was revealed to The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّمَ gradually over a period of around 23 years.

The Quran is a source of guidance which tell us about principles of life. By following these principles, a person can achieve success of both the worlds.

Allah has made the recitation of the Quran essential for the Muslims.

Recitation of the Quran is an act of great reward.

There are certain rules for recitation of the Quran and it is necessary for us to follow them.

Activity for the students

Students should recite from the Holy Quran, one after the other in front of the teacher while taking care of the manners of reciting it, and practically demonstrate the manners of recitation.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions.

1. State the meanings of the word 'Quran'.
2. How long did it take for the Holy Quran to be revealed?
3. Write down any three manners of recitation of the Quran.
4. What is meant by Ta'awwuz and Tasmiyah?

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. The Quran was revealed through Angel:

(A) Hazrat Jibreel عليه السلام	(B) Hazrat Mikael عليه السلام
(C) Hazrat Israfeel عليه السلام	(D) Hazrat Izraeel عليه السلام
2. Reciting one letter of the Holy Quran yields:

(A) Five good deeds	(B) Ten good deeds
(C) Fifteen good deeds	(D) Twenty good deeds
3. The most recited book in the world is:

(A) Torah (The Old Testament)	(B) Injeel (The New Testament)
(C) Zaboor (The Psalms)	(D) Holy Quran

3. Fill in the blanks.

1. The Quran was revealed on Allah's last *Rasool* _____.
2. The best person is the one who learns _____ and teaches it to others.
3. Ta'awwuz and _____ should be recited before the recitation of the Quran.
4. It is necessary to be _____ before touching the Quran.

4. Match the words in column 1 with appropriate words in column 2 to complete the sentences:

Column 1	Column 2
1. A person who acts upon the instructions of the Holy Quran	one needs to purify him/herself.
2. Responsibility of guarding the Quran	in a beautiful and pleasant manner.
3. Before touching the Holy Quran,	is taken by Allah himself.
4. The Quran should be recited	can attain success in both the worlds.

Instructions for the teachers

- Provide students with additional information about the importance of the Quran.
- Explain the students about the virtues of reciting the Quran with manners and understanding it.